foreword

I have been a big fan of Manning *In Action* books over the years, and they have been a significant part of my professional career. I love how the books focus on practical, useful, hands-on advice about the various technologies I use, both for work and in open source.

It was in that same spirit that I sat down to write Elasticsearch many years ago. I got into search while trying to build a recipe application for my wife as she was studying to be a chef. I open-sourced the code I wrote to implement it, thus taking my first step into the open source world. And a few years later, I sat down to write Elasticsearch, trying to create a useful, practical, easy-to-use search engine—search in action, if you will.

Fast-forward to 2023, and I'm delighted to see that Elasticsearch has gained traction and has its own addition to the *In Action* series, which you are now holding in your hands or looking at in digital form. I am sure you will enjoy reading the book and learning about Elasticsearch. Madhu is passionate about both search and Elasticsearch, and it comes across in the depth and breadth of this book, the enthusiastic tone, and the hands-on examples.

I hope that after learning about Elasticsearch, you will take what you have read and put it "in action." After all, search is everywhere, in everything we do, which is why I fell in love with it so many years ago.

—SHAY BANON, FOUNDER OF ELASTICSEARCH